

D202

Human Growth and Development

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 4-year-old at a busy daycare with three rooms watches a teacher pour juice from a short, wide cup into a tall, thin glass. The child, who just had a birthday party, insists the tall glass holds more juice. In Piaget's theory, what does the child lack, and in which stage is the child?

- A. Object permanence; sensorimotor stage.
- B. Conservation; preoperational stage.
- C. Conservation; concrete operational stage.
- D. Attention, due to excitement after the party; not a stage issue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A child can now explain that a flattened ball of clay has the same amount as before, but struggles with purely hypothetical “what if” problems. Which Piaget stage is the child in?

- A. Sensorimotor.
- B. Concrete operational.
- C. Preoperational.
- D. Formal operational.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 16-year-old who plays varsity soccer and works weekends at a grocery store keeps switching friend groups, styles, and career plans as he tries to figure out who he is. His parents recently moved to a larger house. Which Erikson stage is he working through?

- A. Industry vs. inferiority.
- B. Intimacy vs. isolation.
- C. Identity vs. role confusion.
- D. Autonomy vs. shame and doubt.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In Erikson's theory, a 50-year-old who feels she has contributed little to the next generation and focuses only on herself is showing which outcome?

- A.** Isolation.
- B.** Stagnation.
- C.** Despair.
- D.** Generativity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a lab playroom stocked with new toys, a 14-month-old explores freely while her mother is present, cries when the mother leaves, and is quickly comforted when she returns. The session lasted 20 minutes and was recorded on video. Which attachment style does this show?

- A.** Insecure-resistant.
- B.** Insecure, because any crying at separation signals insecurity.
- C.** Insecure-avoidant.
- D.** Secure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A pharmacist who runs half-marathons learns she is pregnant. Her clinic is 30 minutes from home. During which period is the developing child most vulnerable to major structural birth defects from teratogens such as alcohol?

- A.** The embryonic period, about weeks 3 to 8.
- B.** The fetal period, from week 9 to birth.
- C.** Risk is equal throughout pregnancy.
- D.** The germinal period, the first two weeks.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Parents of a 10-year-old in a quiet suburb set clear rules about homework and screen time, explain the reasons behind them, and listen when their child disagrees, sometimes adjusting the rules. Both parents work as engineers. Which parenting style is this?

- A. Permissive.
- B. Authoritarian.
- C. Uninvolved.
- D. Authoritative.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A parent demands strict obedience, gives rules without explanation, and uses punishment instead of discussion. Which style is this, and which outcome does research most often link to it?

- A. Permissive; children who struggle with self-control.
- B. Authoritative; children with high self-esteem.
- C. Authoritarian; children who tend to be more anxious and less socially confident.
- D. Authoritarian; the strongest academic and social outcomes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 72-year-old retired librarian who volunteers at a museum twice a week scores higher than ever on vocabulary and general-knowledge tests but takes longer than she used to on timed puzzles with new rules. Which pattern does this reflect?

- A. Early dementia.
- B. All intelligence declining steadily after 65.
- C. Crystallized intelligence holding or rising while fluid intelligence declines.
- D. Fluid intelligence rising while crystallized intelligence declines.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task relies most on fluid intelligence?

- A.** Defining difficult words.
- B.** Recalling facts about world history.
- C.** Applying skills learned over a 30-year career.
- D.** Solving a new kind of logic puzzle under time pressure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A second-grade teacher at a school with a new playground notices a student cannot solve two-step word problems alone but can when the teacher asks guiding questions and then gradually steps back. The class has 24 students. In Vygotsky's terms, where do the problems fall, and what is the teacher doing?

- A.** In the zone of proximal development; scaffolding.
- B.** Assimilation and accommodation.
- C.** At the child's independent level; no support is needed.
- D.** Beyond the child's readiness; the teacher should wait until the child matures.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

After his wife of 45 years died, a retired carpenter who still builds birdhouses first insisted she would be home soon, later felt angry at her doctors, and some weeks after seeming calmer grew angry again. Which statement best fits the Kübler-Ross model?

- A.** He moved from denial to anger, and returning to anger is a normal part of grief.
- B.** He is in bargaining.
- C.** His grief is abnormal because the stages must occur in strict order.
- D.** He has reached acceptance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 4-year-old ~~at a busy daycare with three rooms~~ watches a teacher pour juice from a short, wide cup into a tall, thin glass. The child, ~~who just had a birthday party~~, insists the tall glass holds more juice. In Piaget's theory, what does the child lack, and in which stage is the child?

Target word: missing ability and stage **Decides:** Age 4 and a failed conservation task.

A	Adjacent category	Object permanence is an infant milestone the child already has.
B	Correct	Preoperational children judge amount by appearance and do not yet conserve.
C	Confusion set	Concrete operational is where conservation is gained, not lacked.
D	Camouflage	The party does not explain a classic conservation error.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A child can now explain that a flattened ball of clay has the same amount as before, but struggles with purely hypothetical “what if” problems. Which Piaget stage is the child in?

Target word: reverse: from abilities to stage **Decides:** Conserves, but no abstract reasoning yet.

A	Confusion set	Infancy stage built on senses and movement, before language-based reasoning.
B	Correct	Conservation is present; abstract thought is not.
C	Inverted operation	Preoperational children fail conservation.
D	Adjacent category	Formal operational thinkers handle hypotheticals.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A 16-year-old ~~who plays varsity soccer and works weekends at a grocery store~~ keeps switching friend groups, styles, and career plans as he tries to figure out who he is. ~~His parents recently moved to a larger house.~~ Which Erikson stage is he working through?

Target word: Erikson stage **Decides:** An adolescent trying out roles to form a sense of self.

A	Camouflage	Answers the sports and job achievements; that stage belongs to school-age children.
B	Adjacent category	The next stage, centered on close relationships in young adulthood.
C	Correct	The adolescent task is building a stable identity.
D	Confusion set	A toddler stage about independence.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

In Erikson's theory, a 50-year-old who feels she has contributed little to the next generation and focuses only on herself is showing which outcome?

Target word: reverse: from the struggle to the pole **Decides:** Middle adulthood, negative resolution.

A	Confusion set	Isolation is the young-adult failure of intimacy.
B	Correct	The negative pole of generativity vs. stagnation.
C	Adjacent category	Despair belongs to late adulthood's review of life.
D	Inverted operation	That is the positive pole she has not reached.

5. Answer D Concept 3

In a lab playroom ~~stocked with new toys~~, a 14-month-old explores freely while her mother is present, cries when the mother leaves, and is quickly comforted when she returns. ~~The session lasted 20 minutes and was recorded on video.~~ Which attachment style does this show?

Target word: attachment style **Decides:** Quickly comforted on the caregiver's return.

A	Confusion set	Resistant infants are upset but not easily soothed on return.
B	Absolute language	Separation distress is normal in secure infants.
C	Inverted operation	Avoidant infants show little distress and ignore the return.
D	Correct	Exploration, distress at separation, and quick comfort on reunion.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A pharmacist ~~who runs half marathons~~ learns she is pregnant. ~~Her clinic is 30 minutes from home.~~ During which period is the developing child most vulnerable to major structural birth defects from teratogens such as alcohol?

Target word: most vulnerable prenatal period **Decides:** Major organs form in the embryonic period.

A	Correct	Organ formation makes this the peak window for structural defects.
B	Adjacent category	Harm still occurs, but defects are usually functional or growth-related, not major structural ones.
C	Absolute language	Sensitivity varies by what is forming.
D	Confusion set	Exposure then tends to be all-or-nothing, not the peak for structural defects.

7. Answer D Concept 5

Parents of a 10-year-old ~~in a quiet suburb~~ set clear rules about homework and screen time, explain the reasons behind them, and listen when their child disagrees, sometimes adjusting the rules. ~~Both parents work as engineers.~~ Which parenting style is this?

Target word: parenting style **Decides:** Clear rules plus warmth and explanation.

A	Adjacent category	Permissive parents are warm but set few limits.
B	Confusion set	Authoritarian parents give rules without explanation or discussion.
C	Inverted operation	Low warmth and low structure, the opposite of this family.
D	Correct	High structure with high warmth and open discussion.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A parent demands strict obedience, gives rules without explanation, and uses punishment instead of discussion. Which style is this, and which outcome does research most often link to it?

Target word: reverse: from behavior to style and outcome **Decides:** High control, low warmth, no explanation.

A	Adjacent category	Permissive parents set few limits; this parent sets many.
B	Confusion set	Authoritative parents explain rules and show warmth.
C	Correct	Heavy control without warmth is linked to weaker social and emotional outcomes.
D	Inverted operation	Those outcomes are most often linked to authoritative parenting.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A 72-year-old retired librarian ~~who volunteers at a museum twice a week~~ scores higher than ever on vocabulary and general-knowledge tests but takes longer than she used to on timed puzzles with new rules. Which pattern does this reflect?

Target word: pattern of intellectual aging **Decides:** Knowledge up, speed on novel tasks down.

A	Adjacent category	Slower novel problem solving alone is typical aging, not a sign of dementia.
B	Absolute language	Her vocabulary scores rose.
C	Correct	Accumulated knowledge grows; novel, speeded reasoning slows.
D	Inverted operation	Swaps the two types.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

Which task relies most on fluid intelligence?

Target word: reverse: from the type to a task **Decides:** Fluid = novel problems, speed, no prior knowledge.

A	Inverted operation	Vocabulary is crystallized knowledge.
B	Confusion set	Stored knowledge: crystallized.
C	Adjacent category	Expertise draws on accumulated, crystallized knowledge.
D	Correct	Novel reasoning and speed are fluid abilities.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A second-grade teacher ~~at a school with a new playground~~ notices a student cannot solve two-step word problems alone but can when the teacher asks guiding questions and then gradually steps back. ~~The class has 24 students.~~ In Vygotsky's terms, where do the problems fall, and what is the teacher doing?

Target word: zone and teacher action **Decides:** Can't do it alone, can with support that fades.

A	Correct	Guided success on tasks just beyond independent ability, with support withdrawn over time.
B	Confusion set	Piaget's terms for adapting mental schemas.
C	Dropped element	Ignores that the child cannot solve the problems alone.
D	Adjacent category	A readiness view; Vygotsky stresses guided learning now.

12. Answer A Concept 8

After his wife of 45 years died, a retired carpenter ~~who still builds birdhouses~~ first insisted she would be home soon, later felt angry at her doctors, and some weeks after seeming calmer grew angry again. Which statement best fits the Kübler-Ross model?

Target word: interpret the pattern **Decides:** Reactions recur; the stages are not a fixed sequence.

A	Correct	The stages describe common reactions that can repeat or overlap.
B	Confusion set	Bargaining is "if only" thinking; the stem describes denial and anger.
C	Absolute language	The model is not a required sequence.
D	Inverted operation	Renewed anger shows he is still working through grief.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Piaget's cognitive stages	Sensorimotor (0-2, object permanence) → preoperational (2-7, no conservation, egocentric) → concrete operational (7-11, conservation, logic about real things) → formal operational (11+, abstract and hypothetical thought).	Placing conservation errors in the sensorimotor stage, or crediting concrete thinkers with abstract reasoning.	Pouring liquid between containers; reshaping clay; "what if" problems.
2	Erikson's psychosocial stages	Each life stage centers on one conflict: e.g., industry vs. inferiority (school age), identity vs. role confusion (adolescence), intimacy vs. isolation (young adult), generativity vs. stagnation (middle adult), integrity vs. despair (late adult).	Picking the neighboring stage, or naming the positive pole when the person is stuck.	Age plus the person's central struggle.
3	Attachment styles	Secure infants explore with the caregiver present, show distress at separation, and are comforted on return; avoidant infants ignore the return; resistant infants are not soothed; disorganized infants show confused behavior.	Treating any separation distress as insecure attachment.	Behavior at the caregiver's return.
4	Prenatal critical periods	The embryonic period (about weeks 3-8) is when organs form and major structural defects from teratogens are most likely.	Assuming risk is equal across pregnancy or highest late.	"Most vulnerable to major structural defects."
5	Parenting styles	Authoritative = high warmth, high structure, explained rules; authoritarian = high control, low warmth, "because I said so"; permissive = warm, few limits; uninvolved = low on both.	Confusing authoritative with authoritarian.	Are rules explained and open to discussion?
6	Fluid vs. crystallized intelligence	Crystallized intelligence (knowledge, vocabulary) holds or grows with age; fluid intelligence (speed, novel problem solving) declines gradually.	Saying all intelligence declines with age.	Vocabulary strong but new, timed puzzles slower.
7	Zone of proximal development	The ZPD is what a learner can do with guidance but not alone; scaffolding is support that is withdrawn as skill grows.	Waiting for readiness instead of guiding, or confusing Vygotsky's terms with Piaget's.	Can't do it alone, can with hints.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Grief and the Kübler-Ross model	Denial, anger, bargaining, depression, and acceptance are common reactions, but they are not a fixed sequence; people move back and forth.	Treating the stages as a strict order that signals abnormal grief when broken.	A person returns to an earlier reaction.

Course scope (public description): This is Human Growth and Development, a three-module course that examines the entire human lifetime, from conception to death. Presented chronologically, the course focuses on three key areas: physical, cognitive, and psychosocial growth, along with other important issues such as cultural influences, emotions, and resilience. Because the course is self-paced, you may move through the material as quickly or as slowly as you need to, with the goal of demonstrating proficiency in the four competencies covered in the final assessment. If you have no prior knowledge of this material, you can expect to spend 30-40 hours on the course content.